

NatWest Group Interview Experience (Internship)

About NatWest Group

NatWest Group, formerly known as RBS Group is a British banking and insurance holding company based in Edinburgh, Scotland. It is considered one of the “Big Four” banks in the UK. It is also known as a bank of brands offering personal and business banking, insurance and corporate finance.

Eligibility Criteria

- 6.0 CGPA from 10th onwards
- No current arrears

Selection Process

1. Online Assessment (Offline at CUIC)
2. Pre-Placement Talk (Offline at CUIC)
3. Technical + HR Interview (Offline at CUIC)

Preparation Overview

The coding questions were mostly array based and on the easier side. Try to solve questions on Leetcode, Hackerrank, GeeksForGeeks to improve your problem solving skills so you can easily solve the questions. Find a study sheet or plan you like and try to fully solve it to help cover all the fundamentals and give you direction. Make sure you understand the solutions instead of trying to memorize them. This understanding will also help you clearly explain your solution if you are asked a DSA problem in the interview as well as to improve your chances in online assessments.

Since the aptitude questions required careful consideration and time management, try to solve aptitude questions on pattern completion, graphs and chart analysis, logical reasoning, and English aptitude on IndiaBIX or other platforms to get a better idea.

Go through common interview questions and study DSA, OOPS, DBMS, OS, Networks, and SDLC concepts, as well as the fundamentals of at least one programming language.

Be confident in everything you include in your resume. Anything you mention in your resume is fair game to be asked and expected to be answered with clarity. If you are not confident, exclude it. Have a good understanding of your projects and be ready to explain them and answer follow up questions.

Online Assessment

It was conducted on the SHL Platform at CUIC. It consisted of 4 sections that could be completed in any order.

1. English Aptitude (15 minutes, 12 questions, no free navigation)

- Reading comprehension, detecting what is wrong with the sentence, finding the synonym/antonym, finding the correct sequence of sentences, etc.
- IndiaBIX English aptitude has many similar questions.

2. General Aptitude (36 minutes, 24 questions, no free navigation)

- This section was totally different from other aptitude questions I've seen online and in other online assessments.
- The questions required basic arithmetic and logical reasoning, but what made it difficult was the totally different format, time constraint and lack of free navigation, making time management crucial.
- It was interactive and had questions that required us to select dates, schedule meetings, assign rooms based on a given criteria, adjust bar graphs and pie charts to reflect correct percentage values which are to be calculated based on given information, as well as to determine the next pattern given a sequence.
- There was an option to attend a practice test, and if this option is available, please opt for it to complete it as it helped me get acquainted with the format and helped me to avoid wasting time during the actual test

3. Coding (45 minutes, 2 questions, free navigation)

- The driver code was provided and only the required function needed to be implemented, though this is not the case for many companies where you need to code from scratch.

- However if you require any data structure or algorithm that is not already included, you will have to explicitly add the header or import it yourself
- The questions were both easy level array-based questions
- Each participant randomly received a different set of questions.

Question 1: Return the odd-indexed elements of an array after sorting it in ascending order

Input : [3, 1, 6, 6, 5, 7]

Output : [3, 6, 7]

Question 2: Return the maximum perfect square within a given range. The question was straightforward, but not so explicitly given

Input : [3, 26]

Output : 25

4. SQL (15 minutes, 10 questions, free navigation)

- Query based questions were asked where we were supposed to determine the output, guess the query based on output, as well as conceptual questions.

It seemed that the aptitude section was the deciding factor in many cases in terms of who got shortlisted, but doing well on the coding and other sections will always improve your chances.

23 students were shortlisted after this round. The shortlist was announced the same week the day before the interview.

Technical + HR Interview

It took place at CUIC following an offline Pre-Placement Talk (PPT). In general, there was only one round of interview for panels with two members, though some panels had only one member and those students had to go through two rounds of interviews.

First, the interviewers introduced themselves and then I did the same. Try to prepare something short but memorable about yourself, your experiences or your goals. Though I was

visibly nervous in the beginning, the conversational nature of the interview helped me feel less nervous.

They asked me follow up questions based on my introduction and then asked me questions about one of my projects, my contributions, how I would handle certain situations relating to the project such as if the other contributors are not willing to implement my ideas.

Then I was asked to write a simple SQL join query after which I was asked what language I felt was my strongest. Since I had answered Java, I was then asked general Java questions like what is garbage collection, error handling, Scanner vs BufferedReader, etc.

The flow of the interview is very much guided by your responses and many questions were asked from terms I had mentioned in my answers, so don't mention anything you can't answer a follow up question for. For example, when talking about garbage collection I had off-handedly mentioned the finalize() method and the immediate follow up question was to explain what it was.

I was then asked to write pseudocode for an array-based question. When asked to write pseudocode, always try to explain your train of thought including any brute force solution that comes to mind, and always remember to explain any edge cases that may be present.

Question : Given an array of characters, sequentially print the character and its frequency

Input : [a, a, b, b, b, c, d, d, e]

Output : a2 b3 c1 d2 e1

I was finally asked if I had any questions for them. I asked how I could better equip myself for this internship if given the opportunity. This question turned into a series of HR questions where I was asked how I would learn new things, and what I think is required for effective team collaboration.

Try to prepare a question beforehand based on something that you want to know, or something you learned from the company's PPT etc. The interviewers were very kind and engaging making for an overall good experience.

Finally, 9 students were shortlisted for the internship, and I am very grateful for the opportunity.

General Advice

I'm not sure how qualified I am to give advice :), but from personal experience, the main thing I would stress is to not lose faith in yourself if you are not shortlisted. The mental toll and seriousness of the whole process only sunk in for me when companies actually started coming despite previous warnings. This process has quite a bit of luck involved, but the only thing we can do to improve our chances is to keep practicing, which is hard to do when it feels like there is no end in sight. If you find yourself struggling with this, remember that you are not alone, and many before you have felt exactly the same. So, keep going and may you see the light at the end of the tunnel!

Resources

1. LeetCode, HackerRank, GeeksForGeeks, takeUForward, IndiaBIX
2. <https://leetcode.com/studyplan/leetcode-75/>
3. <https://leetcode.com/problem-list/oizxjoit/>
4. <https://takeuforward.org/interviews/must-do-questions-for-dbms-cn-os-interviews-sde-core-sheet/>
5. <https://takeuforward.org/interviews/strivers-sde-sheet-top-coding-interview-problems>
6. C.O.D.E series conducted by ACM-CEG

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All the best!